UHLB2122

PROFESSIONAL COMMUNICATION SKILLS 1

SECTION 55

GROUP 2

WRITING REPORT:

TITLE：PREPARING STUDENTS FOR THE AI ERA: INTEGRATING RELEVANT SKILLS INTO MODERN EDUCATION

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SECTION 55

1.0 INTRODUCTION

Artificial intelligence (AI) is changing how we live, work and learn at a dizzying rate. AI is now an everyday reality, ranging from customer service chatbots to smart virtual assistants, and education is no exception. AI applications such as ChatGPT are being used by the majority of universities to aid both teaching and administration. Nonetheless, while the tools are becoming ubiquitous, students are not being equipped for their use to their advantage. According to Walter (2024), students tend to over-reliance or misuse AI tools as they utilize the tools without understanding how they work. On their own, they do not have the AI literacy, technical capabilities, and adaptability that is required for AI-augmented settings. This report explores the reasons behind the gap and provides three viable solutions: building AI literacy, instructing technical capabilities like prompt engineering, and imparting lifelong learning attitudes to prepare students for the future.

2.0 BACKGROUND OF THE PROBLEM

Artificial intelligence (AI) is also transforming the needs of contemporary education. From my viewpoint, incorporating AI in education makes the student not only industry-relevant but also improves necessary critical thinking and problem-solving abilities. Even though AI is already being utilized within higher education, primarily for administrative purposes, its application within teaching and learning is still limited. Some will say that AI tools are already here, but the mere usage of them does not assure student comprehension. As a result, students will use these tools passively, losing out on developing significant skills. This lack of organized AI teaching is concerning the preparedness of students for more digital workplaces.

2.1 CAUSE OF THE PROBLEM

Crompton and Burke (2023) discussed the fact that AI tools tend to work in the background to optimize efficiency but are not creating student knowledge in the process. That only leaves the student benefiting from AI but failing to learn about the nature of what it is doing or how to use it in critical thinking. Besides, AI learning is mainly restricted to technical fields. The majority of non-STEM course students receive zero experience with AI in any form. The educators face a similar knowledge gap as well since the majority lack training or confidence in bringing in AI subject materials to the classroom (Karataş et al., 2024). Consequently, the student is denied equal opportunity to acquire baseline AI knowledge.

2.2 EFFECTS OF THE PROBLEM

The absence of AI education at any level is detrimental both in academia and in the professional world. First, students with little to no foundational knowledge of AI tend to misuse the tools by operating them passively and providing no critical input for the tool's output. Walter (2024) states students often lack the necessary skills for basic tasks which encourages low-level learning and inadequate analysis. Second, outside of the classroom setting, this gap in preparedness can be detrimental to students' future careers. As Qian et al. (2025) explain, modern industries are increasingly searching for professionals that can integrate multiple fields of study while also occupying roles in technology transformation. Students who do not possess knowledge of AI or lack understanding of basic ethics will struggle to compete in innovation-driven sectors. In other words, the absence of a curriculum focused on AI advancements will hinder students' prospects while undermining the aim to nurture adaptable professionals.

3.0 POSSIBLE SOLUTIONS

The following three solutions are proposed to address the issue of student unpreparedness in the face of AI integration.

3.1 INTEGRATING AI LITERACY ACROSS ALL DISCIPLINES

To begin with, AI literacy should be part of overall learning. Crompton and Burke (2023) noted how widespread adoption of AI throughout higher education is generally disconnected from instruction for students. To illustrate, foundational AI concepts like machine learning functionality and how algorithms influence decision-making can prompt students to be more reflective about technology with which they are already familiar. This integration is not a matter of completely overhauling curricula. Instead, AI literacy can be infused in general education courses as it stands, or in compact modules and cross-disciplinary seminars. The primary benefit here is universality, all students regardless of their area of study, acquire a working knowledge of AI. However, this will require institutions to educate faculty members with appropriate training and means, many of whom will themselves lack familiarity with the topic.

3.2 TEACHING PRACTICAL SKILLS LIKE PROMPT ENGINEERING

In addition to understanding what AI is, students need to be taught how to use it efficiently. Walter (2024) advises that the majority of students interact with tools like ChatGPT without learning the process of how to get helpful or correct outputs. This often leads to superficial usage or even misinformation. Teaching students prompt engineering, which is the practice of asking good questions and deciphering AI responses, has the potential to transform how students apply these products to learn and be creative. For example, the students can be assigned to compare and contrast content produced by AI based on different categories of prompts or tune fine outputs based on real-time feedback. The greatest strength of this approach is that it turns students from passive users into vigilant contributors. Nevertheless, it depends on the institution wanting to invest in both upskilling the educators and providing students with guided opportunities to explore these tools more intensely.

3.3 FOSTERING ADAPTABILITY AND LIFELONG LEARNING MINDSETS

Lastly, a significant skill that students need to learn is adaptability. This is due to the reason that AI technology changes quickly and the tools that exist today will likely be much different in a few years' time. Kurtz et al. (2024) presented a four-level model for GenAI integration in education and emphasized the need to cultivate a culture of adaptability in teachers and students alike. Therefore, students who can adapt to new technology, learn independently, and stay interested are better prepared to face the uncertainties of the future workforce. As a sample, universities can encourage this mindset by developing flexible curricula that allow students to experiment with new tools, test unfamiliar platforms and reflect on their learning. In this manner, students not only develop technical expertise but also the self-assurance to learn throughout their lives. While this approach requires a shift from traditional pedagogy, its long-term benefits are invaluable in a world where change is constant.

4.0 CONCLUSION

In general, preparing students for the AI era isn't about getting technology into classrooms, it's about reshaping what education can accomplish. There is a very clear gap between how AI is used and how students are being prepared to use it. Without initiative from the universities, students are open to using software that they do not understand. To move beyond this, institutions must make a deliberate effort: instill AI literacy in all fields of study, train functional skills and encourage lifelong adaptability. These are not Band-Aid solutions, but they set a defined course. By making these changes, universities can ensure that their students are not only keeping up with AI but they are creating the pathway for responsible and innovative use.

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APPENDIX

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